Chapter 34

Vavaatoa – Kite fishing

Naphtali Maion

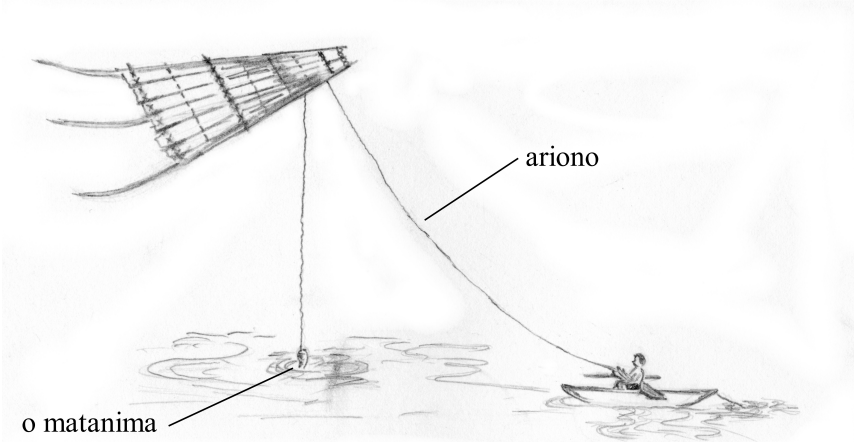


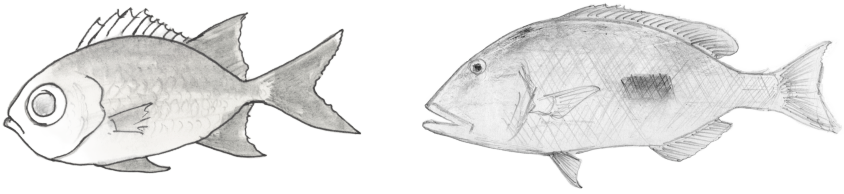
Figure 1: *Vavaatoa* – Kite fishing

(1)	***Vagana vaa tea vavaatoa***	**Fishing with the kite**
(2)	*A vavaatoa na vavaanaovo riori tea iravata.*	They let the kite fly in the wind.
(3)	*Evehee, saka ei haana komana vaan. Ahiki.*	But this is not in the village. No.
(4)	*Na dee riori tahii.*	They take (it) to the sea.

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(5)	*A iravata to vavaanaovo vavaatoa suku riori saka hoa vabeera haana.*	The wind in which they let kites fly does not blow strongly.
(6)	*Bara o puhana to paku riori bona vagana bona saka beera haana mee.*	And the high tide during which they do this fishing is not strong either.
(7)	*A tahii toro ato koa bono takatakaku mooman.*	The sea water only needs to touch your ankles.
(8)	*A vavaatoa na vakis ni riori bona buaku a kanono ariono.*	They tie two *ariono* strings to the kite.
(9)	*A peha ariono na vakis nana matana vavaatoa, a vaabuaku na vakis nana murinae.*	One *ariono* string is tied to the front of the kite, the second one is tied behind it.
(10)	*A too vagana na ato kaakoo batana tea ariono vaa matana.*	The fisherman holds the string that is tied to its front.
(11)	*A matanima he na hana batana tea ariono vaa teo vamurina.*	The *matanima*, the hook of the kite, hangs on the *ariono* string in the back.
(12)	*Beori vaanaovo bono vavaatoa, saka vaanaovo pinopino haa riori.*	When they let the kites fly, they do not let them fly carelessly around.
(13)	*Na tara rori bona matanima be tei koa toonuna tahii,*	They see that the *matanima* just stays on the surface of the sea,
(14)	*ore paa vaantee koa bari teebona.*	and then they let it stop there.
(15)	*A too vagana be pita mi bona vavaatoa, a matanima ore paa tereree bata koana toon na tahii.*	When the fisherman walks with the kite, the hook of the kite only hovers over the surface of the sea.
(16)	*O iana toro tara bari be tereree batana, ore paa kao bari,*	The fish will see it when it is hovering over the surface,
(17)	*ore paa kao bari ore paa no koto bari.*	then they approach and bite them.
(18)	*Pasi koto bata nom, beori hana.*	They will bite them, while they are hanging there.
(19)	*A vavaatoa na ponisi nana ore paa rahi gunaha bari,*	The kite is heavy, they pull it down,
(20)	*ore paa ato bona iana.*	and then they (the fishermen) grab the fish.
(21)	*Eve koa to paku bata vo riori, ore suguna komana*	That's how they do it until

(22)	*beo iana bero vaantee bono rake teori, ore paa voosu vahaa.*	they have as many fish as they wanted, and then they return home.
(23)	*Evei o iana to rahirahi maa riori tea vavaatoa,*	These fish that they catch with the kite,
(24)	*saka kavara rio iana haana, ahiki.*	it is not all fishes, no.
(25)	*O iana vai koa (1) hori, (2) hoohoa, (3) pasuaromo, (4) ponpon.*	It is only the following fishes: (1) *hori* squirrel fish, (2) *hoohoa* needle fish, (3) *pasuaromo* emperor, (4) *ponpon* needle fish.
(26)	*Bea tahii masi, ore paa vakavara vagana.*	When the tide goes down, they finish kite fishing.



(a) (b)

Figure 2: (a) *Hori* – squirrel fish, (b) *Pasuaromo* – Emperor



Figure 3: *Hoohoa* – needle fish

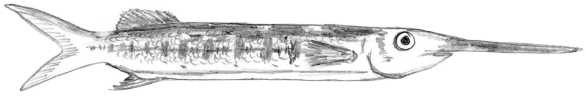


Figure 4: *Ponpon* – needle fish